



Geophysics M.Sc.

Application Information

Application period: 15 February – 31 March (winter term)

Semester start: October 1st (winter term) and April 1st (summer term)

Language(s) of instruction: English

Introduction

The M.Sc. Geophysics is a research-oriented program that offers individual specialisation. Students can choose those lectures from the curriculum of the Institute of Geophysics that best suit their scientific interests. The program is divided into two study phases, beginning with the Advanced Studies phase, where students develop advanced knowledge and understanding in geophysics and related interdisciplinary subjects. This phase is followed by the Research phase, where students specialise in a geophysical research field that eventually becomes the topic of their Master's thesis.

The curriculum of the Institute of Geophysics represents the focus of the working groups in research and teaching:

- Marine geophysics
- Seismology
- Physical volcanology
- Machine learning in geophysics
- Interdisciplinary expertise
- Learning by active participation in research

Students are often involved in international research projects that include field studies and offer an opportunity to further the experience already gained during B.Sc. studies. Correspondingly, field data gained in the context of such a research project is often the basis for a Master's thesis. The main target group for the M.Sc. Geophysics are graduates from B.Sc. programs in or related to geophysics.

The M.Sc. Geophysics of the University of Hamburg has an excellent international reputation. Our graduates are highly sought-after for research, development, administration, and industry.

Admission Requirements

University Degree

- A Bachelor's degree in the consecutive B.Sc. Geophysik/Ozeanographie of the Faculty for Mathematics, Informatics, and Natural Sciences of the University of Hamburg or
- a Bachelor's degree in an equivalent subject or
- a Bachelor's degree in a mathematical or physical program where a minimum of 90 ECTS credit points coincides with the curriculum of the B.Sc. Geophysik/Ozeanographie of the Faculty for Mathematics, Informatics, and Natural Sciences of the University of Hamburg. Of the aforementioned 90 ECTS credit points, a minimum of 45 ECTS credit points must be acquired in mathematics and/or physics.

Furthermore, a minimum of 6 ECTS credit points in computer programming is required. Please elaborate on your programming skills in your CV and/or application letter.

If you have not received your degree certificate yet, you can submit this by the end of the first semester of your master's program. Please see the "Documents to Submit" section below for details.

Additional Special Admission Requirements

Proficiency in English language is required and must be proved by any of the following certificates:

- a) Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) B2 or
 - b) International English Language Testing System (IELTS) Academic Test with a minimum score of 5.5 or
 - c) Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) internet-based test with a minimum score of 72 points or
 - d) Cambridge First Certificate in English (FCE), Cambridge Certificate of Advanced English (CAE), Cambridge Certificate of Proficiency in English (CPE) or
 - e) a minimum of seven years in English at a German high school or by equivalent certification, where the equivalency is determined by the admission board.
- In particular, mere completion of a B.Sc. degree taught in English does not fulfil the admission requirements.

For details of the legal basis for this regulation, please see the admission bylaws for your chosen degree program: www.uni-hamburg.de/zugang-master

Recognition of Transcripts for Degree Programs Completed at Foreign Higher Education Institutions

If you obtained your first degree abroad, your certificate will be reviewed during the application procedure in the faculty of your program.



If your degree certificate is not in English or German, please include a copy of a certified English or German translation of the certificate with your application documents.

If you obtained your higher education entrance eligibility abroad, you will need to apply for recognition of your higher education entrance eligibility in addition to your application for a degree program.

You can find all information on how to apply for recognition here: www.uni-hamburg.de/vpd

Application

Online Application

You will need to complete the online application available on University of Hamburg's application portal during the application period: www.uni-hamburg.de/online-application. Please create a user account, enter your information online, upload the required documents to your online application and submit your application online.

The application procedure for the master program is an online procedure. This means that you do not need to submit any documents in paper form or via email to Universität Hamburg. Instead, you have to upload the documents. Selection is based on the information you provide online and the documents you upload.

If you want to submit an additional special application (e.g., hardship application), you will need to send this special application separately via the online application portal together with the required proofs as an upload by the application deadline. For more information on special applications, please see www.uni-hamburg.de/sonderantrag and www.uni-hamburg.de/info-master

Documents to Submit

Please upload the mandatory documents listed below in pdf format to the application portal. For documents not issued in English or German, an electronic copy of a certified English or German translation is required.

- Your online application
- Degree certificate or provisional Transcript of Records
If you are still studying when you apply and cannot yet provide a final certificate containing your grades, please submit your current Transcript of Records confirming your provisional grade point average. You will then need to submit your degree certificate by the end of the first semester of your master's program.
- Higher education entrance eligibility
- Application letter detailing the motivation for the study of geophysics with regard to your interest in the subject and in further academic training. The application letter should be no longer than two pages and address the following questions:

- What has been your interest in geophysics to date? Which topics did you focus on particularly during your first degree, e.g., in your bachelor's thesis?
- Are there any topics from your first degree that you would like to continue and explore in greater depth during your master's degree at the University of Hamburg? If so, which ones?
- Which of the specializations offered in Hamburg are you particularly interested in?
- Why would you like to complete the master's program in Geophysics at the University of Hamburg?
 - Please elaborate on your programming experience.
- Brief CV including professional experience and/or internships in the field of geophysics
- If applicable, documentation of computer programming experience
- English language certificates

Selection Criteria

Selection will be based on the following criteria, for which the relevant supporting documents must be submitted with the application by the deadline:

- a) Results of the first professionally qualifying university degree or average grade at the time of application;
- b) Comparability of the completed degree programme with the Bachelor's degree programme in Geophysics/Oceanography at the Faculty of Mathematics, Informatics and Natural Sciences;
- c) Motivation of the choice of study programme based on a specified guideline, maximum two pages in length.

Criteria b) and c) are assessed according to the grading scale of the examination regulations. Criterion a) is weighted at 40%, criteria b) and c) at 30% each.

Admission and Enrollment

Once your application has been reviewed, an acceptance or rejection letter will be made available in your STiNE account under the Dokumente (Documents) tab. Please see the information at www.uni-hamburg.de/online-application . An enrollment deadline will be indicated in your acceptance letter - please submit the documents required for enrollment by this date. The enrollment process is an online process. Detailed information about the enrollment process is provided at www.uni-hamburg.de/masterenrollment .



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FAKULTÄT

MATHEMATIK, INFORMATIK
UND NATURWISSENSCHAFTEN

Contact

PD Dr. Claudia Vanelle

claudia.vanelle@uni-hamburg.de

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